

Phase 1

Brainstorming and Ideation Phase

Project: **Implement Client Script & UI Policy (Incident)**

Item	Details
Platform	ServiceNow (Incident Management)
Organization	SmartBridge
Team ID	SWTID-2026-3598
Team Size	5
Team Leader	VEERAMANI B
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1. Introduction

Incident records are the backbone of IT service management. Every incident that reaches a service desk is triaged, routed to the right group, prioritised and resolved against an SLA. The quality of that process depends on the quality of the data entered when the incident is created or updated. This phase captures how the team identified the problem, explored possible solutions and arrived at the final idea: enforcing data quality directly in the ServiceNow user interface using **UI Policies** and **Client Scripts**.

2. Problem Statement

Incident records often require consistent and accurate data entry to support effective triage, routing and resolution. Relying only on user awareness and manual checks leads to incomplete, inconsistent or incorrect data being submitted. This affects reporting accuracy, SLA compliance and overall service quality. There is a need to enforce conditional field behaviour and validation at the user-interface level so that Incident records meet defined business rules before they are submitted.

2.1 Typical data-quality issues observed

- High-impact incidents saved without an assignment group or an assignee, delaying response.
- Urgency set to a low value while Impact is High, producing an inconsistent Priority.
- Users editing the State field directly from list views and bypassing the validations present on the form.
- Mandatory fields that apply only in some situations (for example, only for High impact) being missed because they are not enforced dynamically.

3. Objective

To demonstrate how ServiceNow client-side controls enforce data integrity on Incident records by dynamically making fields mandatory, auto-populating values, controlling field behaviour (read-only / visible) and preventing record submission when required conditions are not met.

4. Empathy Map (Service Desk Agent / Incident Manager)

Says	Thinks	Does	Feels
"This incident has no assignee." "Why is urgency Low for a critical outage?"	Bad data will break my SLA reports and slow the resolver teams.	Manually checks each incident, chases callers, corrects fields after the fact.	Frustrated by rework; anxious about SLA breaches; wants guard-rails built into the form.

5. Brainstorming - Ideas Considered

#	Idea	Pros	Cons	Decision
1	Train users and publish data-entry guidelines	Cheap, no configuration	Not enforceable; depends on human behaviour	Rejected

#	Idea	Pros	Cons	Decision
2	Business Rules (server-side) to block bad data	Strong enforcement, cannot be bypassed	Feedback only after save; poor user experience	Keep as future enhancement
3	UI Policies only	No code, easy to maintain	Cannot show save-time validation or complex logic	Used for mandatory/read-only
4	Client Scripts only	Flexible logic	Code for simple behaviours that UI Policies already provide	Used for logic UI Policy cannot do
5	UI Policy + Client Scripts (onChange, onSubmit, onCellEdit)	Instant feedback, lightweight, uses best-practice for each tool	Client-side only; can be bypassed via API/imports	Selected

6. Proposed Solution (Selected Idea)

A combination of one UI Policy with two actions and three Client Scripts, all triggered by the **Impact** field of the Incident table:

- **UI Policy 'High Impact Control'** - when Impact is 1 - High, make Assignment group mandatory; with 'Reverse if false' enabled the change is undone automatically otherwise.
- **UI Policy Action on Urgency** - make Urgency read-only when Impact is High.
- **onChange Client Script** - when Impact changes to High, automatically set Urgency to High and show an information message.
- **onSubmit Client Script** - block the save and show an error box when Impact is High and Assigned To is empty.
- **onCellEdit Client Script** - block direct editing of State from the list view and tell the user to open the incident.

7. Expected Outcomes and Value

- Complete and consistent incident data from the moment of creation.
- Improved SLA compliance and reporting accuracy.
- Reduced rework for service desk agents.
- A reusable pattern for other conditional business rules in ServiceNow.

8. Skills Required

- Incident Management
- UI Policy and UI Policy Actions
- Client Scripts (onChange, onSubmit, onCellEdit)
- Form Validation